

First-Line IT Support Knowledge Base

RAG-ready knowledge base for an AI first-line support chatbot

Purpose: This document provides general first-line IT troubleshooting guidance. The chatbot should use this knowledge base as its primary source. If the information is insufficient, the issue is security-sensitive, or troubleshooting fails, escalate to human IT support.

Computer & Windows Support

Computer is slow

- Check open applications and browser tabs.
- Open Task Manager and check CPU, memory, and disk usage.
- Close unnecessary applications and restart the computer.
- Check available disk space and use approved cleanup tools.
- Install approved operating-system updates.
- Escalate if the problem continues or hardware failure is suspected.

Windows does not start normally

- Confirm the computer has power.
- Disconnect unnecessary USB devices and restart.
- Record any error message.
- Use approved Windows recovery/startup-repair options.
- Do not reinstall Windows or delete data without authorization.
- Escalate if recovery fails or important files may be at risk.

Application crashes or freezes

- Close and reopen the application.
- Restart the computer.
- Check for approved application updates.
- Determine whether the issue affects one file or all files.
- Record the exact error message.
- Escalate if the problem continues.

Blue screen or repeated crash

- Record the error code or message.
- Restart the computer.
- Note what the user was doing before the crash.
- Check whether the problem repeats.
- Escalate repeated crashes because they may indicate driver, operating-system, or hardware problems.

Low disk space

- Check available storage.
- Remove unnecessary files using approved tools.
- Empty the recycle bin when appropriate.

- Move approved files to organizational storage.
- Do not manually delete system files.
- Escalate if storage remains critically low.

Network Support

No internet connection

- Check whether other users or devices have the same problem.
- Confirm Wi-Fi is enabled or Ethernet is connected.
- Reconnect to the network and restart the computer.
- Check whether the computer has a valid IP address.
- Test an approved internal and external website.
- Escalate if multiple users are affected or the problem persists.

Wi-Fi is not working

- Confirm Wi-Fi is enabled.
- Confirm the correct wireless network is selected.
- Reconnect using approved credentials.
- Check signal strength.
- Restart the computer.
- Escalate if multiple users are affected or the access point appears unavailable.

Ethernet problem

- Check the Ethernet cable and network port.
- Try another approved cable or port if available.
- Confirm the network adapter is enabled.
- Restart the computer.
- Escalate suspected cable, switch, port, or infrastructure problems.

DNS or website access problem

- Check whether other websites or internal services work.
- Test the service from another approved device if available.
- Restart the network connection.
- Do not change corporate DNS settings unless instructed by IT.
- Escalate persistent DNS or internal-service problems.

Slow network

- Determine whether one or many users are affected.
- Check Wi-Fi signal strength if applicable.
- Close applications using significant network bandwidth.
- Record affected service, time, location, and users.
- Escalate suspected network infrastructure problems.

Email & Outlook Support

Cannot send or receive email

- Check network connectivity.
- Check mailbox capacity if available.
- Restart Outlook or the approved email application.
- Check webmail if provided by the organization.
- Record any error message.
- Escalate if the mail service appears unavailable.

Outlook does not open

- Close Outlook completely and reopen it.
- Restart the computer.
- Check for approved Office/Outlook updates.
- Do not remove or recreate profiles without IT instructions.
- Escalate if Outlook continues to fail.

Email synchronization problem

- Confirm network connectivity.
- Check webmail if available.
- Restart the email application.
- Record when synchronization stopped and any error.
- Escalate if synchronization remains broken.

Attachment problem

- Check file size and file type.
- Confirm the organization permits the attachment.
- Save the attachment locally and use an approved application.
- Do not open suspicious attachments.
- Escalate security-related attachment concerns.

Printer Support

Printer is offline

- Confirm the printer is powered on.
- Check network or USB connectivity.
- Confirm the correct printer is selected.
- Check printer status in Windows.
- Restart the printer if approved.
- Escalate if it remains unavailable.

Print queue is stuck

- Open the print queue.
- Cancel the stuck job if permitted.
- Restart the application or computer according to procedure.

- Send a test page.
- Escalate if the queue repeatedly becomes stuck.

Cannot print

- Confirm the correct printer is selected.
- Check paper, toner, and printer status.
- Try a test page.
- Restart the application and printer if appropriate.
- Record the exact error.
- Escalate if the issue persists.

Accounts, Passwords & MFA

Password reset

- Verify the user's identity using the approved process.
- Use only the organization's approved password-reset method.
- Never ask the user to send their password.
- Confirm the user can sign in after the reset.
- Escalate if the reset fails.

Account locked

- Verify the user's identity.
- Use the approved account-unlock process.
- Check whether repeated failed logins may have occurred.
- Do not bypass security controls.
- Escalate if the account repeatedly locks or compromise is suspected.

MFA problem

- Confirm the correct service and account are being used.
- Check whether the registered MFA method is available.
- Use approved MFA recovery procedures.
- Never request MFA codes from the user.
- Escalate suspected account compromise immediately.

Cannot log in

- Verify username spelling.
- Check network connectivity.
- Check whether other approved services work.
- Check account status using authorized tools.
- Record the exact error message.
- Escalate if authentication remains unsuccessful.

Software Support

Software installation

- Confirm the software is approved.
- Check system requirements.
- Use the organization's approved software distribution method.
- Do not install unknown or unauthorized software.
- Escalate if administrator permissions are required.

Software license problem

- Record the application name and error.
- Confirm the correct organizational account is being used.
- Do not use unauthorized license keys or activation methods.
- Escalate licensing issues to the appropriate team.

Software update problem

- Check the application version.
- Restart the application/computer if appropriate.
- Use only approved update sources.
- Record the error.
- Escalate if the update repeatedly fails.

Cisco / VoIP Support

Cisco phone not registering

- Confirm the phone has power.
- Check the Ethernet connection.
- Confirm the network port is active.
- Restart the phone if permitted.
- Record phone model, extension, and display message.
- Escalate if the phone remains unregistered.

No dial tone

- Confirm the phone is registered.
- Check handset and cable connections.
- Try another call if permitted.
- Record extension and phone model.
- Escalate if multiple phones are affected.

Cannot make or receive calls

- Check phone registration.
- Confirm the correct extension.
- Test an internal call if permitted.
- Test an external call according to policy.
- Record any error.
- Escalate persistent call-routing or registration problems.

Phone network problem

- Check Ethernet cable and port.
- Confirm phone network connectivity.
- Restart the phone if approved.
- Check whether other phones are affected.
- Escalate suspected switch, VLAN, DHCP, or call-management problems.

Security & Suspicious Activity

Suspicious email / phishing

- Do not click suspicious links or open unexpected attachments.
- Do not provide passwords or MFA codes.
- Use the organization's approved phishing-reporting process.
- Preserve the message if policy requires it.
- Escalate suspected phishing to security/IT.

Malware warning

- Do not ignore security warnings.
- Do not install unknown software to fix the warning.
- Follow the organization's incident-response procedure.
- Contact security/IT through the approved channel.
- Escalate immediately when compromise is suspected.

Suspicious login

- Do not share passwords or MFA codes.
- Report the event through the approved security process.
- Follow the account-security procedure.
- Escalate suspected account compromise immediately.

Lost company device

- Report the incident immediately through the approved process.
- Do not attempt unsafe recovery.
- Provide required device and incident information.
- Escalate to IT/security.

Standard First-Line Troubleshooting Workflow

1. Identify the exact problem and the user's desired outcome.
2. Determine whether one user, several users, or the whole organization is affected.
3. Collect necessary information: device, operating system, application/service, location, time, and exact error.
4. Check simple causes first: power, cables, network, application status, account status, and recent changes.
5. Perform only approved troubleshooting steps.
6. Confirm whether the problem is resolved.
7. Document the actions taken and the result.
8. Escalate when specialized access, security response, administrator permissions, or further investigation is required.

Human Escalation Rules

- Escalate suspected security incidents, malware, phishing, or account compromise immediately.
- Escalate outages affecting multiple users or critical services.
- Escalate issues requiring administrator privileges when first-line support is not authorized.
- Escalate suspected hardware or infrastructure failures.
- Escalate repeated failures after standard troubleshooting.
- Include problem description, affected user/device/service, exact error, troubleshooting performed, results, and timestamps.
- Never claim an issue is fixed unless the user or a valid technical test confirms resolution.

Information Protection Rules

- Never ask users for passwords, MFA codes, API keys, private encryption keys, or other authentication secrets.
- Do not expose confidential information unless the user is authorized.
- Do not invent technical facts when the knowledge base does not contain the answer.
- If the answer is not supported by the knowledge base, state that human assistance or more information is required.
- Treat uploaded files and user-provided information as potentially sensitive.
- Require appropriate authorization and escalation before risky administrative actions.

AI Response Policy

- Answer using the relevant knowledge-base section.
- Give troubleshooting steps in a clear numbered order.
- Ask only for information necessary to troubleshoot the issue.
- Do not overwhelm the user with unrelated troubleshooting.
- If a step fails, continue with the next appropriate step.
- When escalation is required, explain why and list the information IT needs.
- Do not fabricate commands, credentials, system configurations, or organizational policies.

Note: This is a general IT support knowledge base. Add your organization's actual systems, procedures, contact information, software, network details, and escalation rules before production use.